

The role of social media.

Social media are computer-mediated technologies that facilitate the creation and sharing of information, ideas, career interests and other forms of expression via virtual communities and networks.

Social media "mining": *Look for the definition.*

The process of obtaining data from user-generated content on social media in order to extract actionable patterns, form conclusions about users, and act upon the information. Mining supports targeting advertising to users or academic research.

Fake News: *look for the definition*

false stories that appear to be news, spread on the internet or using other media, usually created to influence political views or as a joke

Confirmation bias: *look for the definition*

People's tendency to process information by looking for, or interpreting, information that is consistent with their existing beliefs. This biased approach to decision making is largely unintentional, and it results in a person ignoring information that is inconsistent with their beliefs. These beliefs can include a person's expectations in a given situation and their predictions about a particular outcome. People are especially likely to process information to support their own beliefs when an issue is highly important or self-relevant.

Echo chamber: *look for the definition*

In news media and social media, an **echo chamber** is an environment or ecosystem in which participants encounter beliefs that amplify or reinforce their preexisting beliefs by communication and repetition inside a closed system and insulated from rebuttal. An echo chamber circulates existing views without encountering opposing views, potentially resulting in confirmation bias. Echo chambers may increase social and political polarization and extremism. On social media, it is thought that echo chambers limit exposure to diverse perspectives, and favor and reinforce presupposed narratives and ideologies.

Post-truth: *look for the definition*

An adjective defined as 'relating to or denoting circumstances in which objective facts are less influential in shaping public opinion than appeals to emotion and personal belief'.

News silos / the silo effect: *look for the definition*

a silo effect in which people only watch news that confirms their preexisting worldview. These news silos insulate viewers from opposing points of view, leaving them in a feedback loop that reinforces their partisan opinions

Google declared as an illegal monopoly on search (EU's fine): *look for information*

In a major blow to Google, the European Court of Justice confirmed a 2.4 billion-euro fine levied by the European Commission. The penalty was confirmed in support of a prior ruling of the General Court for anti-competitive behavior in manipulating search results to favor its shopping service over those of rivals.

Today's decision of the Court confirms that, by favoring its own shopping platform on its general results pages through better display and positioning, Google has infringed the antitrust rules of the Treaty. "By today's judgment, the Court of Justice dismisses the appeal and thus upholds the judgment of the General Court," stated the court in a press release.

A. The Royal family and the media: find out information

Prince Harry and Meghan Markle:

Meghan Markle harassed by the British media and particularly the tabloids → racist comments

Prince Harry sued Rupert Murdoch's tabloids for invading his privacy (cf. phone hacking scandal)

Prince Harry and Meghan Markle used Oprah Winfrey's show to harshly criticise the Royal Family

How to deal with the health of the Royals? King Charles and Princess Catherine

After months of speculation on her abdominal surgery, Princess Catherine had to publish a video revealing she had cancer in March 2024. A year after, she announced she was in remission.

Buckingham palace announced King Charles was diagnosed with cancer in February 2024. In March 2025, he has to be hospitalized because of the side effects of his treatment.